

**ASA Section on Statistics and the Environment Newsletter
Summer Edition 2026**

Keep up to date on ENVR events and opportunities via the [ENVR website](#)

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MESSAGE FROM THE ENVR CHAIR

Dear ENVR section members,

I hope you are having a great summer.

Let me start by congratulating the ENVR award winners and new Fellows! It is wonderful for your work to be recognized. I would like to thank the awards committee (Alex Schmidt (chair), Huiyan Sang, and Amy Braverman), student paper competition committee (Eric Gilleland (chair), Soutir Bandyopadhyay, and Abhirup Datta) and the fellows committee (Mevin Hooten (chair) and Robert Lund).

Let me also take this opportunity to thank all the ENVR board members for their hard work. We have an exciting JSM planned, with the ENVR student mentoring roundtable on August 4 at noon, the student paper award presentations on August 5 at 10.30am, as well many other exciting scientific sections sponsored by our section. I look forward to seeing everyone at the ENVR business meeting and mixer at JSM: August 3, 5-7pm in W-Marina Ballroom, Westin Boston Seaport District.

Looking to the fall, the 2026 ENVR Workshop will be held in Houston, TX on October 8-10, 2026. Thank you to Mikyoung Jun and Kathy Ensor for co-chairing a diligent organizing committee. Registration will open later in the summer. The scientific program is already shaping up nicely!

I hope to see many of you at JSM or the 2026 ENVR workshop.

Peter Craigmile
2026 ENVR Chair

ENVR AWARDS AND NEW FELLOWS

New ASA Fellow

Jonathan Bradley, University of Missouri
Snigdhasu Chatterjee, University of Maryland Baltimore County
Dorit Hammerling, Colorado School of Mines
Jiwei Zhao, University of Wisconsin-Madison

New IMS Fellow

Yong Chen, University of Pennsylvania
Hsin-Cheng Huang, Academia Sinica, Taiwan
Bo Li, Washington University in St. Louis

ENVR Distinguished Achievement Award

Ying Sun, King Abdullah University of Science and Technology
Citation: For distinguished and sustained contributions to environmental statistics through advances in spatial and spatio-temporal modeling, high-performance statistical computing, and impactful interdisciplinary applications across climate, air quality, water, and renewable energy, and for outstanding mentoring and service to the environmental statistics community.

ENVR Early Investigator Award

Won Chang, Seoul National University
Citation: For fundamental contributions to statistical methods for computer model emulation and calibration with high-dimensional and non-Gaussian spatial data, and for impactful interdisciplinary applications to climate science, including ice sheet modeling, precipitation processes, and environmental risk, advancing uncertainty quantification in complex environmental systems.

Francis Hui, The Australian National University
Citation: For pioneering the development and application of joint species distribution models for community ecology, formulating cutting-edge methodological, computational, and software techniques for the model-based analysis of multivariate correlated data, and for advances in model-based clustering, model selection, and spatio-temporal analysis in environmental and ecological statistics.

ENVR Student Paper Competition

Winners:

Xindi Lin, "Safe, Cost-Effective Spatial Policy Learning With Application to Nitrate Mitigation Policy in Wisconsin Groundwater," University of Wisconsin-Madison
Katherine Kreuser, "Physical–Statistical Modeling for Estimating Storm Surge r-Year Return Levels," Clemson University
Maha Moussa, "AI-Guided Single-Index Varying–Coefficient Logistic Modeling: A Rain–Snow Partitioning Case Study," Utah State University

Honorable Mentions:

Stephen Tivenan, "A Statistical Framework for Spatial Boundary Estimation and Change Detection: Application to the Sahel–Sahara Climate Transition," Virginia Commonwealth University

Yanran Li, "Spatially Adaptive Ensemble Learning with Calibrated Predictive Uncertainty," Columbia University

NEWLY ELECTIVE ENVR BOARD MEMBERS

Chair-Elect 2027: **Matthew Heaton**, Brigham Young University

Council of Sections Representative 2027-2029: **Ander Wilson**, Colorado State University

Program Chair Elect 2027: **Toryn Schafer**, Texas A&M University

Treasurer 2027 (Rotates to Secretary): **Yawen Guan**, Colorado State University

ENVR MIXER AND BUSINESS MEETING

Plan ahead to attend the ENVR Mixer at JSM in Boston. We will recognize award winners, discuss upcoming events, discuss the state of ENVR, and enjoy catching up with one another.

Date: Monday, August 3, 2023

Time: 5:00PM - 7:00PM

Location: Westin Boston Seaport District, W-Marina Ballroom 2

ENVR WORKSHOP OCTOBER 8-10, 2026

Save the date for the 2026 ENVR Workshop in Houston, TX, USA October 8-10. The workshop will feature 2 half-day short courses, an invited scientific program, contributed poster presentations, and social events and networking. Contributed poster abstract submission and student and early-career travel support applications are now open. More information, including registration information, is available on the [ENVR website](#).

JSM 2026 MESSAGE FROM THE PROGRAM CHAIR

Dear all,

We have an exciting ENVR program at JSM 2026. Schedule of the ENVR sessions and events are given below. Looking forward to seeing you in Boston.

Best,
Lyndsay

Sun, Aug 2, 2026

- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: Novel Methods for High-Dimensional Space-Time Data, Contributed Papers
- 4:00 PM - 5:50 PM: Statistical methods for leveraging passive data collection strategies for inference and prediction, Topic-Contributed Paper Session
- 4:00 PM - 5:50 PM: Bayesian Spatio-Temporal health modeling and surveillance, Invited Paper Session*

Mon, Aug 3, 2026

- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Data Oddities: Novel Approaches to Handling Imperfect Temporal, Spatial and Spatio-Temporal Data, Contributed Papers
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: Building Ecological and Environmental Knowledge and Assessing Impact on Communities from Community Scientists and Sensors, Topic-Contributed Paper Session
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: Sustainable AI Deployment and Opportunities for Statistical Practice, Invited Panel Session*
- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: Is Spatial Statistics Dead – Replaced by AI?, Invited Paper Session
- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: A Showcase of Advancements in Methods for Environmental Data, Contributed Papers
- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: Causal Inference with Interference: What Network and Spatial Statisticians Can Teach Each Other, Topic-Contributed Paper Session*
- 5:00 PM – 7:00 PM: ENVR business meeting and mixer at JSM

Tue, Aug 4, 2026

- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Recent Advances in Spatial Modeling for Modern Environmental Applications, Invited Paper Session
- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Advances in Point Process Modeling in the Social and Environmental Sciences, Topic-Contributed Paper Session
- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: The NISS–IMSI Data Science at the Intersection of Environment and Public Health Program, Topic-Contributed Paper Session*
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: Short- to Mid-term Forecasting for Weather, Natural Hazards and Energy Applications, Contributed Papers
- 12:00 PM - 1:00 PM: ENVR Student Mentoring Roundtable
- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: Modern AI and Statistical Methods for Environmental Extremes and Risk Assessment, Contributed Papers
- 4:00 PM - 5:50 PM: Space-Time Methods for Animal Movement, Contributed Papers
- 4:00 PM - 5:50 PM: Modern Statistical Approaches for Complex Environmental Exposure Mixtures, Topic-Contributed Paper Session*
- 4:00 PM - 5:50 PM: New Horizons in UQ: Innovations at the Interface of Statistics, Mathematics, and Machine Learning, Invited Paper Session*

Wed, Aug 5, 2026

- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Deep learning for statistical inference on spatial data, Invited Paper Session
- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Addressing Confounding in Spatial Causal Inference, Topic-Contributed Paper Session*
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: ASA ENVR Section student paper awards, Topic-Contributed Paper Session

- 2:00 PM - 3:50 PM: Novel Approaches to the Scalability Challenges of Spatial and Space-Time Inference, Contributed Papers

Thu, Aug 6, 2026

- 8:30 AM - 10:20 AM: Statistical and Machine-Learning Innovations for Understanding Climate Extremes and Uncertainty, Invited Paper Session
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: Modeling Complexity at the Climate–Health Interface, Topic-Contributed Paper Session
- 10:30 AM - 12:20 PM: From Paleoclimatology to Linguistics - Impactful Applications of Temporal and Spatio-Temporal Methods using Environmental Data, Contributed Papers

* Co-sponsored by the Section on Statistics and the Environment